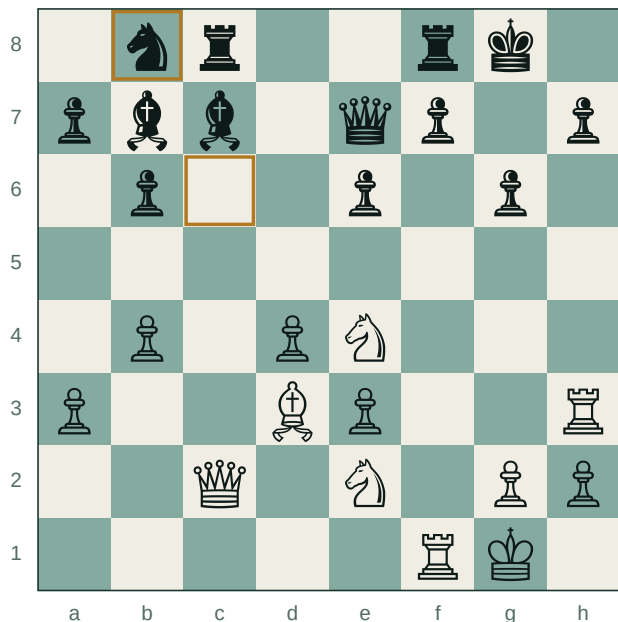


# Kingside attacks: White, move 21

Kingside attacks

White to move



Previous move: 20...Nb8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 21. Nf6+ Qxf6 22. Rxf6

**21.Nf6+** Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **21...Qxf6**.

**22.Rxf6** The rook captures the queen on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 25 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

### CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from +0 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not count distant pieces as attackers unless they can reach useful squares in time. Every preparatory move gives the defender a turn.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A kingside attack succeeds when pieces and pawn breaks create concrete threats near the king. The attack must arrive before the defender can exchange attackers or counter in the center.

### HOW TO LOOK

Count the pieces that can join immediately, identify an entry square, and calculate the defender's checks and exchanges.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: queen on e7 and bishop on b7. Check for tactical protection.